PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Tuesday, August 12, 2025

Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee

Informal Meeting Minutes

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center, 501 N. Dixon St., Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Committee Members:
Director Virginia La Forte (Committee Chair), Vice-Chair Michelle DePass, and Director Rashelle Chase-Miller

Attendees:
Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong - Superintendent
Kara Bradshaw – Executive Assistant, Board Clerk
Margaret Calvert – Assistant Superintendent, School Planning and Modernization
Kirsten Cowden – Senior Real Estate Manager and Asset Management
Joanna Evenson – Director of Construction
Dr. Jon Franco – Senior Chief of Operations
Natasha Garcia – Project Manager
Marshall Haskins – Senior Director, Athletics
Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff
Liz Large – Contract Senior Legal Advisor
Tom Olgers – Chief of Integration Officer
Rosanne Powell – Senior Board Manager
Stormy Shanks – Senior Director of School Modernization
Christy Splitt – Board Member
Sharon Toncray – Chief Legal Officer
Eddie Wang – Board Chair
Dana White – Director, Planning & Property Management

Called to Order / Introduction

The meeting was called to order at 4:32pm by Committee Chair Virginia La Forte.

Public Comment

Time: 4:36 pm

Public Comment:
- Gretchen Cole: Expedite the installation of lights at the Grant Bowl.
- Lucy Kapranos: Student at Grant H.S. in support of installing lights at the Grant Bowl.
- Brooke Wesener: Student at Grant H.S. in support of installing lights at the Grant Bowl.
- Ronan Cole: Student at Grant H.S. in support of installing lights at the Grant Bowl.
- Stephanie Antipov: In support of installing lights at the Grant Bowl.
- John Dwyer: Urged the Board to review the seismic upgrade report, and to partner with the Safe Structures Group to facilitate seismic upgrades.
- Effie Greathouse: All school HVAC systems should be upgraded to meet the goal of 6 air changes per hour.

Organizational Topics:

Time: 4:59 pm

Committee Charter

The committee discussed the draft Committee Charter, with topics including, the Long-Range Facilities Plan, committee work vs staff work, allocation of work to other committees, oversight responsibilities, and continued review of the charter.

Work Plan

Staff: Jon Franco

The Committee reviewed and discussed the first draft of its work plan. Staff noted that the plan provides access points for discussion throughout the year and ensures alignment with the work of the Bond Accountability Committee (BAC). Discussion included the frequency of seismic updates and whether the BAC should report to the Committee or directly to the full Board. It was noted that the BAC could present to the full Board while the Committee reserves time on the agenda to address any follow-up items as needed.

Update on 2020 and 2025 Bond Projects

Time: 5:33

Staff: Stormy Shanks

Staff provided an update on the 2020 and 2025 Bond Projects, including high school modernizations, health and safety projects, infrastructure improvements, and planning for the 2025 bond program. They reported on completed and near-complete projects such as water quality, lead paint remediation, and radon mitigation, and suggested allocating the remaining health and safety funds to ADA accessibility improvements. Discussion included the status of the Roosevelt Grandstand expansion, options for use of remaining 2020 bond funds, integrating seismic upgrades with roofing projects, and how facility work aligns with potential school consolidations.

Facility Improvements

Time: 6:03 pm

Athletic Field Projects - Grant Bowl Field Lights

Staff shared provided an update on the Grant Bowl lights project, indicating that with an aggressive timeline they could have lights up by December 1st. They suggested Board members put pressure on outside entities, such as the City of Portland and Portland Parks and Recreation, to expedite the permitting and approvals process. There was discussion regarding the possibility of making progress on other athletic fields improvements at the same time as the other facilities improvements, with a request for an athletics projects sequencing and prioritization timeline by the next meeting.

Seismic Improvements

Staff reported that the seismic report has been received and noted that additional time is needed to review it before being presented at the next meeting. There was a request to invite the structural engineer to attend that meeting if available.

Future Agenda Topics and Next Steps

Time: 6:20 pm

Committee Chair La Forte will work on the agenda for the next meeting.

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned by Committee Chair Virginia La Forte at 6:21 pm.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw

Confidential Executive Assistant / Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools